

A Systematic Literature Review on Implications of Generative AI for IT Management

Seminar paper

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Abstract

Generative Artificial Intelligence is reshaping the role of IT within organizations. IT now plays a central role in strategy, innovation, and governance. This paper systematically reviews the academic literature on GenAI's implications for IT management. Using a structured review method, it examines how GenAI affects IT's strategic role, internal usage, enabling functions, required capabilities, and emerging risks. While the literature confirms GenAI's transformative potential, it remains fragmented and lacks detailed guidance on governance and implementation. Few studies offer solutions to practical challenges, and none focus solely on IT management. This review identifies five key themes, outlines research gaps, and discloses implications for IT leaders. It contributes a structured foundation for understanding GenAI's impact and highlights the need for further empirical research.

Keywords: Generative AI, Generative AI in Organizations, Generative AI Implications.

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1 Introduction

Generative Artificial Intelligence (GenAI) has become a transformative force across multiple industries. Tools like ChatGPT, GitHub Copilot, and DALL-E are reshaping how users interact with technology and perform daily tasks. At the same time, they are significantly changing the way companies manage their IT (Agrawal, 2023; Korzynski et al., 2023; Singla et al., 2025).

Since the release of ChatGPT by OpenAI in November 2022, the discussion about AI has shifted from long-term speculation to immediate strategic relevance - both for individuals and companies (Ryazanov et al., 2024). In 2023, GenAI reached the “peak of inflated expectations” in Gartner's Hype Cycle, showing its widespread awareness (Perri, 2023).

According to a survey by Singla et al. (2025), 71% of companies have already tested GenAI tools, and 17% reported measurable impacts on their business. The numbers are even higher in IT domains such as software development. For example, GitHub Copilot has around 1.2 million users and has been shown to improve programming productivity by up to 55% (Peng et al., 2023). Gartner (2023) predicts that over 80% of organizations will adopt GenAI by 2026. Its global impact on the economy is estimated to be between \$2.6 and \$4.4 trillion (Chui et al., 2023).

IT managers now need to navigate challenges and opportunities. On the one hand, GenAI can accelerate service delivery, reduce manual workload, and enable more data-driven decision-making (Holmström and Carroll, 2024). On the other hand, GenAI introduces new challenges related to governance, implementation, and risk control (Chowdhury et al., 2024). Without a clear strategy, organizations risk fragmented adoption, duplicated efforts, and ethical, legal, and operational vulnerabilities (Schneider et al., 2024).

Despite rising interest, the academic literature on GenAI and IT management is fragmented. While most studies are about use cases and emerging risks, few provide an overview of how GenAI is changing the roles, responsibilities, and practices of IT management. I aim to address this gap.

This paper systematically examines the current academic literature on the implications of GenAI for IT management. It focuses on the strategic and operational aspects of GenAI, including governance, adoption, and the evolving role of IT - both as a user and as an enabler of GenAI.

In the following, IT management refers to the planning, implementation, control, and monitoring of IT systems and services, including their strategic alignment with business objectives (Axelos, 2019; PEPARD and Ward, 2016).

The central research question guiding this review is:

“What is the current state of academic literature on the implications of Generative Artificial Intelligence for IT management?”

In order to answer this question, this paper is structured as follows. Chapter 2 describes the methodology used to conduct the systematic literature review. Chapter 3 presents the results. Chapter 4 discusses commonalities, contradictions, practical implications, and research gaps. Chapter 5 concludes with a summary of the key findings.

2 Method

In order to conduct a structured and rigorous literature review, I followed the five-step method proposed by Wolfswinkel et al. (2013). This approach consists of five iterative steps: define, search, select, analyze, and present. Each step is described in detail below.

Define: In the first step, I defined the scope and selection criteria for the review. The objective was to identify both academic and practitioner-oriented literature that examines the implications of GenAI for IT management. Following Wolfswinkel et al. (2013), I defined five inclusion and exclusion criteria.

Inclusion criteria were that sources be peer-reviewed journal articles, conference papers, or high-quality industry reports published after 2020, with a clear focus on GenAI in the context of IT strategy, operations, governance, or human resources. Exclusion criteria were publications that focused exclusively on domain-specific applications of GenAI without broader relevance, as well as those not written in English or German.

Based on these criteria, I selected the following databases: AISel, IEEE Xplore, EBSCO Business Source Complete, Web of Science Core Collection, Scopus, and Google Scholar.

The search terms were developed iteratively. The final search string is:

Title Search String: "Generative Artificial Intelligence" OR "Generative AI" OR "GenAI" OR "GAI"

Abstract Search String: ("IT management" OR "IT governance" OR "Digital transformation" OR "IT strategy") AND ("Implication" OR "Challenge" OR "Impact" OR "Adoption" OR "Implementation")

Search: In the second step, I searched for relevant papers in the databases. During this phase, I adjusted the search string. This ensured that relevant studies were not overlooked.

Select: The third step was the filtering and selecting of the literature. I began by screening all titles and abstracts for relevance. Duplicates were removed. I then reviewed the full texts of potentially relevant publications, including only those that made a clear contribution to the topic.

To increase coverage, I conducted both backward and forward searches, as recommended by Webster and Watson (2002). I reviewed the reference lists of selected articles (backward search) and used citation tracking tools to identify newer papers citing them (forward search). Each newly found paper went through the selection phase as well.

Analyze: In the fourth step, I analyzed the selected literature using the coding procedure proposed by Wolfswinkel et al. (2013). Open coding was used to identify recurring concepts and ideas. Axial coding grouped these into broader thematic clusters. Selective coding then synthesized these into higher-level analytical dimensions.

This process resulted in five central themes that form the basis of the findings chapter:

- Strategic Role of IT
- IT as a User of GenAI
- IT as an Enabler of GenAI
- Organizational capabilities for GenAI Adoption
- Risks, Ethics, and Legal Implications of GenAI

Present: In the final step, I presented the findings using the five central themes.

3 Findings

This chapter presents the most important findings from the literature review. The analysis follows a concept-oriented approach.

A key distinction in the literature is the dual role of IT: as an internal user of GenAI to improve its own processes, and as an enabler that supports the secure and scalable deployment of GenAI across the organization (e.g., Dwivedi et al., 2013; Ooi et al., 2023). In both roles, IT faces the challenge of managing risks, adapting infrastructure, and supporting experimentation while maintaining control and ensuring alignment with business strategy (e.g., Agrawal, 2023; Chowdhury et al., 2024).

To provide a clear overview, the concept matrix (Appendix 1) summarizes which papers cover which topics. These topics form the basis for the structure of the following subsections.

3.1 Strategic Role of IT

The adoption of GenAI is changing the role of IT in organizations. IT is becoming a strategic actor, actively shaping how GenAI is scaled and aligned with business goals (e.g., Banh et al., 2025; Dwivedi et al., 2023). At the same time, IT leaders must work with institutional pressures, regulatory expectations, and the uncertainty of GenAI and its impact (Manduchi et al., 2024; Naqbi et al., 2024). This demands new capabilities, and also a shift in how IT collaborates, governs, and innovates (Dwivedi et al., 2023; Li et al., 2024).

From Support Function to Strategic Actor

The rise of GenAI is reshaping the role of IT (Dwivedi et al., 2023). It is no longer seen as a support function, but as a driver of business strategy and innovation (e.g., Agrawal, 2023; Chowdhury et al., 2024; Dwivedi et al., 2025). Earlier waves of technology focused on efficiency and scalability (Dwivedi et al., 2025). In contrast, GenAI enables new capabilities like natural language generation (Agrawal, 2023; Banh et al., 2025; Dwivedi et al., 2023). These advances give IT a central role in redefining how organizations create value (Alavi et al., 2024; Haki et al., 2025; Singh et al., 2024). IT leaders are no longer just executing fixed roadmaps; they are now shaping them (Desai and Desai, 2025; Dwivedi et al., 2023). This includes identifying use cases, running GenAI pilots, and aligning efforts with strategic goals (e.g., Gupta, 2024a; Ooi et al., 2025).

Cross-Functional Integration

This strategic shift changes the daily work of IT, as it is no longer only about delivering infrastructure decisions (Ooi et al., 2025). IT must now guide how GenAI is embedded into business processes, workflows, and decisions (Ooi et al., 2025). Because GenAI is general-purpose, it affects many areas - from HR and marketing to customer service and compliance (e.g., Chen et al., 2023; Chowdhury et al., 2024; Naqbi et al., 2024). IT is now responsible for creating platforms that allow business units to experiment with GenAI, while also ensuring compliance, data security, and long-term maintainability (e.g., Agrawal, 2023; Haki et al., 2025). This shift challenges traditional IT operating models, making closer collaboration with business leadership necessary (Agrawal, 2023; Dwivedi et al., 2023). In this context, IT is not only an enabler, but a creator of business capabilities (Dwivedi et al., 2023; Haki et al., 2025; Ooi et al., 2025).

Strategic Uncertainty

Adopting GenAI comes with uncertainty (Agrawal, 2023). Many IT leaders are navigating unclear goals, unstable tools, and evolving norms (Agrawal, 2023; Chowdhury et al., 2024; Manduchi et al., 2024). Despite this, firms often feel pressure to act quickly (Haki et al., 2025). The fear of falling behind pushes companies to adopt GenAI even when internal readiness is low (e.g., Dwivedi et al., 2023; Gupta and Rathore, 2024; Naqbi et al., 2024). IT must support learning and adaptation rather than simply executing predefined plans (e.g., Dwivedi et al., 2023; Haki et al., 2025). For small and medium-sized enterprises (SMEs), this is especially difficult. Resource limitations raise the risk of uncoordinated or misaligned initiatives (Agrawal, 2023; Malik-Kozłowska and Kozłowski, 2025; Rajaram and Tinguely, 2024).

At the same time, institutional pressures are rising (Chen et al., 2023). Regulators, customers, and industry bodies expect responsible AI use (e.g., Dwivedi et al., 2025; Moharrak and Mogaji, 2024). IT is often asked to ensure compliance with norms around privacy, fairness, and transparency (Chen et al., 2023; Rajaram and Tinguely, 2024). Nidhisree et al. (2024) point out that IT is now involved in ethical and reputational concerns, especially as GenAI becomes more visible externally. This puts IT in a boundary-spanning position, with the need to balance technical feasibility, risk, and regulation (e.g., Joshi et al., 2025; Manduchi et al., 2024; Onatayo et al., 2024).

Governance, Task Forces, and Strategic Signaling

To manage these pressures, some firms are creating GenAI task forces. These often include IT, legal, and HR (Dwivedi et al., 2023; Malik-Kozłowska and Kozłowski, 2025). Such teams are more common in firms that see GenAI as a strategic shift, not a short-term tool (e.g., Dwivedi et al., 2023; Rajaram and Tinguely, 2024). Where these teams exist, IT helps align technical progress with ethical and legal goals (Chowdhury et al., 2024; Naqbi et al., 2024; Singh et al., 2024). In firms without such structures, IT may end up owning GenAI efforts by default (e.g., Ettinger, 2025; Schneider et al., 2024).

IT also plays a role in strategic signaling (Li et al., 2024). It helps shape the organization's AI narrative for investors, executives, and partners (Li et al., 2024). These narratives now influence funding, talent, and alliances (Dwivedi et al., 2023; Reznikov, 2024; Smith, 2025). Early adoption of GenAI is often used to showcase innovation, even if business value is still uncertain (Dwivedi et al., 2023). IT is not only building the technical base, it is also managing expectations, setting milestones, and positioning the company as an innovation leader (Agrawal, 2023; Moharrak and Mogaji, 2024).

3.2 IT as a User of GenAI

The use of GenAI in IT departments leads to a notable shift in how teams manage their own work (Rajaram and Tinguely, 2024). IT is no longer limited to building infrastructure or supporting integrations (Dwivedi et al., 2025). Instead, GenAI is now used to write code faster and automate internal tasks (e.g., Malik-Kozłowska and Kozłowski, 2025; Ooi et al., 2025). GenAI reduces manual effort, shortens development time, and frees up capacity for more complex challenges (e.g., Agrawal, 2023; Li et al., 2024; Ooi et al., 2025).

Software Engineering

GenAI is changing how IT teams build software (Li et al., 2024). It automates tasks that once required manual work and gives developers new tools to work with (e.g., Li et al., 2024; Storey et al., 2025). One key function is code generation (Agrawal, 2023). GenAI systems can translate natural language inputs into executable code (e.g., Banh et al., 2025; Haki et al., 2025). This helps teams build prototypes faster and supports less experienced developers (Li et al., 2024). Code completion is another area of change, with tools like GitHub Copilot that can analyze existing code and suggest the next steps (e.g., auto-complete) (Banh et al., 2025; Dwivedi et al., 2023; Li et al., 2024). This speeds up development and makes outcomes more consistent across teams (Alavi et al., 2024; Naqbi et al., 2024).

GenAI is also being applied to legacy systems. Older codebases can be refactored or rewritten into modern languages, reducing technical debt. However, while the benefits are clear, oversight remains essential. Several studies warn that GenAI can still produce insecure or flawed code, and recommend human oversight (e.g., Banh et al., 2025; Naqbi et al., 2024).

Operational Automation

GenAI is also changing how IT teams manage operations (Li et al., 2024; Ooi et al., 2025). It automates routine tasks, reduces overhead, and improves response time (Li et al., 2024; Ooi et al., 2025). One example is documentation: GenAI can generate summaries of code in real-time, which supports maintainability and improves handovers (Banh et al., 2025; Li et al., 2024; Onatayo et al., 2024). Testing is another area of impact. GenAI can create test cases, simulate different inputs, and flag bugs by comparing outputs to expected results (e.g., Calyam et al., 2025; Chen et al., 2023; Haki et al., 2025).

In IT support, GenAI is now used to help with common issues such as password resets or technical queries (e.g., Dwivedi et al., 2025). It pulls information from internal knowledge bases and guides users through basic steps (e.g., Naqbi et al., 2024). Instead of replacing staff, it helps control requests, allowing human teams to focus on more complex problems (e.g., Alavi et al., 2024; Dwivedi et al., 2023).

Cybersecurity

In the cybersecurity domain, GenAI introduces new opportunities and risks (Ooi et al., 2025). IT teams use GenAI to simulate cyberattacks or penetration test scenarios that help show system vulnerabilities before they are exploited (Gupta et al., 2023; Hilario et al., 2024; Ooi et al., 2025). This allows organizations to strengthen their defenses and evaluate response protocols under realistic attack conditions (Dwivedi et al., 2025; Gupta et al., 2023; Hilario et al., 2024).

However, there are also risks. GenAI can be misused to write phishing messages or hide malicious code (Chen et al., 2023; Dzhaparov, 2024). As a result, IT must deploy GenAI for defense and also monitor how it might be abused (Dzhaparov, 2024; Gupta et al., 2023). Auditing and policy enforcement are becoming increasingly important (Chen et al., 2023; Dzhaparov, 2024; Gupta et al., 2023).

Synthetic Data

In many industries, access to high-quality data is limited by regulation, for which GenAI can offer a workaround (Alavi et al., 2024; Dzhaparov, 2024). IT teams can use it to generate synthetic data that reflects real patterns without exposing sensitive information (Alavi et al., 2024). This supports training and testing while reducing privacy risks (e.g., Alavi et al., 2024; Dzhaparov, 2024).

3.3 IT as an Enabler of GenAI

As GenAI is being used in business areas such as marketing, HR, legal, and finance, the role of IT is shifting (Agrawal, 2023; Dwivedi et al., 2025). IT now also helps other departments adapt to it (Agrawal, 2023; Onatayo et al., 2024). This includes technical aspects, risks, and aligning tools with business needs (e.g., Chowdhury et al., 2024; Dwivedi et al., 2023).

Infrastructure Provisioning

Providing infrastructure is a core part of IT's enabling role (Haki et al., 2025). Business units rely on IT to create safe and flexible environments for using GenAI, including API access, sandbox platforms, or enterprise-scale connections to models like GPT or Gemini (Agrawal, 2023; Lee, 2025; Parthasarathy et al., 2025).

IT teams are responsible for building secure systems that support experimentation while maintaining control (e.g., Joshi, 2024; Onatayo et al., 2024). Often, this means setting up cloud environments, managing access rights, and linking GenAI systems to existing IT infrastructure (Gadde, 2024; Gupta et al., 2023). The key is finding the right balance: Systems must be open enough to allow innovation, but controlled enough to avoid risk - especially as many departments lack the skills to assess those risks independently (Agrawal, 2023; Parthasarathy et al., 2025).

Business Enablement and Functional Coordination

Beyond infrastructure, IT also helps business teams make sense of GenAI's potential. IT works with them to identify practical use cases and bring those ideas to life (Dwivedi et al., 2023; Ettinger, 2025). This often includes playbooks, advisory support, or embedded technical staff who collaborate on new applications (e.g., Desai and Desai, 2025; Haki et al., 2025).

In these settings, IT plays a translator role as it bridges the gap between technical capabilities and operational goals - turning workflows into GenAI solutions (Desai and Desai, 2025; Kumar et al., 2023).

Risk Management, Compliance, and Shadow AI

As GenAI becomes easier to access, some business units adopt it without involvement of the IT department (Chowdhury et al., 2024). This trend, known as 'Shadow AI', can create serious risks (Dwivedi et

al., 2023). Tools used without oversight may expose sensitive data, break compliance rules, or damage the firm's reputation (e.g., Chowdhury et al., 2024; Dwivedi et al., 2023).

To manage this, IT is putting policies and controls in place (Chowdhury et al., 2024). These include usage guidelines, data access restrictions, and monitoring tools (e.g., Dwivedi et al., 2023; Ooi et al., 2025). Agrawal (2023) emphasizes that such policies need to be flexible. Each department handles different types of data and uses GenAI in different ways (Dwivedi et al., 2025). This puts IT in a challenging position. It must support innovation while keeping systems secure and compliant. Meeting both goals requires strong policies, technical safeguards, and training for business users (e.g., Dwivedi et al., 2023; Haki et al., 2025).

Vendor Management and Ecosystem Integration

IT also plays a central role in managing external vendors. It evaluates tools for compatibility, security, and reliability before they are used inside the company (Chen et al., 2023; Ding et al., 2024; Malik-Kozłowska and Kozłowski, 2025). This includes checking how vendors handle data and whether their tools meet enterprise standards (Ferrari et al., 2023; Mondal et al., 2023).

Integration is not just technical. IT must connect APIs, set up authentication, and ensure the tools work within the organization's infrastructure (Gupta et al., 2023). Without IT oversight, these tools can become isolated and hard to govern (Agrawal, 2023; Joshi et al., 2025). Strong vendor and ecosystem management is essential (Agrawal, 2023). It ensures that GenAI tools can scale safely and align with the organization's goals (e.g., Agrawal, 2023; Dwivedi et al., 2023; Gupta et al., 2023).

3.4 Organizational Capabilities for GenAI Adoption

The effective use of GenAI in IT management depends on more than just tools and infrastructure. Organizations also need to build the right capabilities, governance models, and skills. GenAI raises the need for agile and cross-functional IT teams that can adapt to changes and uncertain outcomes (e.g., Desai and Desai, 2024; Gupta et al., 2023).

Skills, Talent, and Workforce Readiness

A key challenge is workforce preparedness (Dwivedi et al., 2023). GenAI requires new technical skills – for example, prompt engineering, fine-tuning models, and integrating outputs into workflows - that go beyond traditional IT roles (e.g., Dzhaparov, 2024; Gupta & Rathore, 2025; Orchard and Tasiemski, 2023). To keep up, IT departments need continuous learning and upskilling programs (Desai and Desai, 2025; Gupta et al., 2023). Firms that lack internal expertise often rely on external consultants. While this can help in the short term, it may increase dependency and reduce sustainability (e.g., Alavi et al., 2024; Rajaram and Tinguely, 2024). The gap is even wider in SMEs, where limited resources make it harder to explore GenAI while maintaining daily operations (Agrawal, 2023; Dwivedi et al., 2023; Dzhaparov, 2024; Gupta et al., 2023).

Governance

GenAI adoption also challenges IT governance (Schneider et al., 2024). The risks it introduces - such as hallucinations, IP leakage, or algorithmic bias - do not fit easily within traditional controls (Schneider et al., 2024).

As a result, decision-making models must evolve (Dwivedi et al., 2025). They need to include continuous review cycles, risk escalation paths, and flexible testing protocols (e.g., Agrawal, 2023; Joshi et al., 2025; Storey et al., 2025). Some firms are moving toward adaptive governance, which can bring together technical, legal, and ethical perspectives and support iterative control (e.g., Chowdhury et al., 2024; Dwivedi et al., 2023; Gupta et al., 2023).

This is especially important in sectors like finance and healthcare, where explainability and auditability are required by law (Moharrak and Mogaji, 2024; Rajaram and Tinguely, 2024). In these settings, IT

must ensure GenAI systems meet evolving compliance standards (Moharrak and Mogaji, 2024; Rajaram and Tinguely, 2024).

Cross-Functional Collaboration

GenAI adoption also relies on culture and collaboration (e.g., Agrawal, 2023; Dwivedi et al., 2023). Without support from business units, even well-designed solutions may fail to scale or deliver value (e.g., Agrawal, 2023; Dwivedi et al., 2023). IT leaders must act as translators and therefore, align technical options with business needs, set realistic expectations, and support experimentation (e.g., Agrawal, 2023; Chowdhury et al., 2024; Desai and Desai, 2025).

Cultural barriers often slow down GenAI initiatives (Agrawal, 2023). Many organizations are not yet ready to accept trial-and-error learning or to rethink long-established workflows (e.g., Agrawal, 2023; Dwivedi et al., 2023; Naqbi et al., 2024). Without a willingness to rethink processes and experiment at scale, even well-designed GenAI systems may fail to deliver value (Dwivedi et al., 2025).

Organizational capability is not just about tools or data (Dwivedi et al., 2023; Ettinger, 2025). It includes mindset, structure, and adaptability (Dwivedi et al., 2023; Ettinger, 2025). For GenAI to become a source of innovation and advantage, IT leaders must help build the culture and provide a framework that supports it (Dwivedi et al., 2023; Ettinger, 2025).

3.5 Risks, Ethics, and Legal Implications of GenAI

Deploying GenAI brings new strategic potential but also introduces new risks (Agrawal, 2023; Dwivedi et al., 2025). These include legal, ethical, and security challenges that IT leaders must address (e.g., Agrawal, 2023). CIOs and IT managers are responsible for putting safeguards in place and guiding their organizations through uncertain terrain (e.g., Dzhaparov, 2024; Haki et al., 2025). These responsibilities cover data protection, liability, fairness, model quality, and protection against malicious use (e.g., Dzhaparov, 2024; Haki et al., 2025).

Data Privacy

A key legal concern is data privacy (Orchard and Tasiemski, 2023). GenAI models often rely on large datasets that may include sensitive or identifiable information (Golda et al., 2024; Orchard and Tasiemski, 2023). This creates compliance risks under laws like the GDPR or CCPA (Chowdhury et al., 2024; Dzhaparov, 2024; Haki et al., 2025). Many firms cannot trace what data their GenAI tools were trained on or how outputs might expose sensitive information (Golda et al., 2024). Even enterprise tools can reintroduce sensitive material if trained on internal documents (e.g., Calyam et al., 2025; Dwivedi et al., 2023; Golda et al., 2024).

To manage this, IT teams are applying controls like access restrictions, differential privacy, and red-teaming techniques to detect data leaks (Feffer et al., 2024; Golda et al., 2024; Singh et al., 2024).

These measures must be embedded early, as privacy cannot be introduced later (Haki et al., 2025). This makes coordination between IT, legal, and data protection teams essential from the design phase (e.g., Dwivedi et al., 2023; Golda et al., 2024; Orchard and Tasiemski, 2023).

Ethical Risks: Bias, Hallucination, and Accountability

GenAI systems are prone to generating incorrect or biased outputs (e.g., Alavi et al., 2024; Banh et al., 2025; Chowdhury et al., 2024). These outputs can damage trust, especially when used to support decisions (Desai and Desai, 2025; Golda et al., 2024). Agrawal (2023) and Dwivedi et al. (2023) caution that even when GenAI is framed as an assistant, its persuasive tone may lead users to accept false conclusions.

Accountability is another concern. It is often unclear who is responsible for outcomes based on GenAI suggestions. Is it the developers, IT teams, or end users (Dzhaparov, 2024; Rajaram & Tinguely, 2024; Silva et al., 2024)?

To address this, governance frameworks must clarify roles and explainability requirements (Joshi et al., 2025). IT leadership must also promote internal AI ethics guidelines covering fairness, transparency, and human oversight (Dwivedi et al., 2023; Malik-Kozłowska and Kozłowski, 2025).

Security Threats

GenAI also creates new attack surfaces (e.g., Agrawal, 2023; Gupta et al., 2023). One example is prompt injection, where adversaries exploit model inputs to extract sensitive data or manipulate outputs (Dwivedi et al., 2025; Golda et al., 2024; Gupta et al., 2023). Model leakage is another threat. If a system is fine-tuned on internal content, attackers may use targeted prompts to reverse-engineer confidential data (Calyam et al., 2025; Gupta et al., 2023).

To counter these risks, IT teams are applying multiple layers of defense, including, for example, API limits, prompt filtering, and detailed logging (e.g., Chennabasappa et al., 2025; Gupta et al., 2023; Joshi et al., 2025). Like other cybersecurity tasks, GenAI security requires ongoing monitoring and model hardening (e.g., Calyam et al., 2025; Dwivedi et al., 2025; Joshi et al., 2025).

Governance Responses

Due to the complexity of GenAI, many firms are investing in dedicated AI risk governance (Manduchi et al., 2024). These include cross-functional committees and oversight boards to monitor ethical, legal, and operational risks (e.g., Dwivedi et al., 2025; Golda et al., 2024; Joshi et al., 2025).

Effective GenAI governance is proactive (Dwivedi et al., 2025; Gupta et al., 2023). It focuses on identifying problems early, rather than reacting to failures after they occur (Dwivedi et al., 2025; Gupta et al., 2023).

IT departments now serve not only as enablers of GenAI adoption but also as its regulators (Agrawal, 2023; Golda et al., 2024). They define safeguards, educate users, and build controls into each stage of deployment (e.g., Dwivedi et al., 2025; Joshi et al., 2025). This evolving role underscores the strategic importance of IT in guiding responsible GenAI innovation (e.g., Dwivedi et al., 2025; Joshi et al., 2025).

4 Discussion

The literature on GenAI in IT management is expanding rapidly but remains fragmented. Most studies agree that GenAI marks a strategic turning point for IT. However, there is less consensus on how prepared organizations are, what roles IT should take on, and how governance should evolve to manage emerging risks.

4.1 Commonalities, Contradictions, and Gaps in the Literature

The literature broadly agrees that GenAI marks a strategic shift for IT management. It is not seen as just another automation tool, but as a technology that redefines how IT contributes to business value. Many sources highlight that IT is moving from a support role to an important factor for outcomes. IT is thus positioned as essential to making GenAI usable, safe, and aligned with enterprise strategy.

However, the treatment of this role varies. Some papers offer views of emerging governance structures, such as cross-functional task forces, while others focus more on challenges like unclear accountability or fragmented ownership. Similarly, while the literature often highlights GenAI's ability to lower barriers in software development, it also flags risks around overreliance, quality, and transparency.

Yet, despite these contributions, the topic remains underdeveloped. Only a few reviewed takes IT management as its primary focus. Most studies consider it as one part of a broader discussion on GenAI in organizations. There is also a lack of detailed, actionable guidance. Few sources go beyond high-level recommendations, and practical solutions to implementation challenges are rarely addressed. Empirical studies are limited, and little is known about long-term impacts. Differences across industries, firm sizes, or IT maturity levels are largely overlooked. SMEs receive minimal attention, and concrete governance

models or capability frameworks for IT leaders are mostly absent. Ethical and legal risks are acknowledged, but detailed integration into IT practices remains an open question.

4.2 Practical Implications

This review highlights several priorities for IT leaders aiming to integrate GenAI:

- **Adopt a dual mandate:** CIOs must balance two roles - enabling GenAI-driven innovation (e.g., code generation, business unit experimentation) and enforcing safeguards (e.g., audits, privacy protocols). Both are core responsibilities of the IT department and cannot be outsourced to other departments.
- **Build GenAI-specific capabilities:** Organizations should invest in targeted upskilling. This includes technical skills such as prompt engineering, as well as non-technical areas like governance design, legal alignment, and ethical risk analysis.
- **Provision enabling infrastructure:** IT should offer secure, flexible platforms and APIs for GenAI experimentation. This reduces reliance on unauthorized tools and allows for standardized access and oversight.
- **Create cross-functional governance bodies:** Organizations should establish AI task forces that include IT, legal, compliance, and business leadership. These teams can align GenAI initiatives with regulatory demands and evolving ethical standards.
- **Implement monitoring and fallback mechanisms:** Especially for high-stakes applications, IT must ensure GenAI systems are observable, explainable, and equipped with human-in-the-loop controls to manage failure cases.

These priorities reflect the evolving strategic role of IT in the GenAI era. To realize the potential of GenAI, IT leaders must take ownership of its integration - technically, organizationally, and ethically.

4.3 Future Research Directions

Several research gaps were identified during the literature review. Along with the limitations of this work, I address the following future research opportunities:

- **Empirical validation:** There is a need for studies to evaluate the actual implications of GenAI on IT management.
- **Sector-specific analysis:** Studies across industries - such as healthcare, finance, and manufacturing - would provide more insights for IT leaders.
- **SMEs:** Existing research focuses mainly on large organizations. SMEs should also be examined, including how SMEs navigate GenAI adoption (barriers, resource limitations, and organizational capacity-building strategies).
- **Operational governance models:** Few studies offer detailed, practice-oriented frameworks for how IT departments can implement GenAI governance mechanisms. Case studies on real-world governance practices are especially lacking.
- **Sociotechnical integration:** Future research should explore how IT can work with HR, legal, compliance, and business leadership when deploying GenAI.

4.4 Limitations

This review is constrained by several limitations. First, the academic literature on GenAI and IT management is still emerging. Many of the sources reviewed were published between 2023 and 2025, and are mostly not peer-reviewed empirical studies.

Second, the scope of the review is focused on strategic, organizational, and governance aspects. Technical, algorithmic, and architectural dimensions of GenAI adoption were not covered in depth.

Third, only sources published in English or German were included. This may have excluded relevant perspectives from other languages or regions, and therefore, cultures.

Finally, the speed at which GenAI technologies and practices are evolving presents a challenge for any static review. Some of my presented results may soon become outdated as the field continues to mature.

5 Conclusion

This review has examined how GenAI is reshaping the field of IT management along five dimensions: First, GenAI is redefining the strategic role of IT. No longer confined to infrastructure or support, IT is increasingly involved in shaping AI strategy, identifying business-relevant use cases, and aligning GenAI initiatives with long-term value creation.

Second, IT departments are also internal users of GenAI. Tools such as GitHub Copilot are being adopted for code generation, and workflow automation. These applications offer productivity gains but also introduce risks - such as hallucinations, quality issues, and opacity - which require new technical and ethical oversight.

Third, the review underscores that successful GenAI adoption depends on organizational capability. This includes workforce upskilling, agile governance, cross-functional collaboration, and the ability to adapt to technological uncertainty. These capabilities are essential to ensuring that IT remains responsive, competent, and aligned with enterprise priorities.

Fourth, IT serves as an enabler of GenAI adoption across the organization. It provides secure infrastructure, supports experimentation, manages third-party integrations, and mitigates risks through proactive governance. In doing so, IT plays a boundary-spanning role between innovation and control.

Fifth, GenAI introduces legal, ethical, and security risks. These range from data leakage and algorithmic bias to adversarial threats. Addressing them requires a shift from reactive compliance to proactive, embedded risk governance.

Appendix 1: Literature Matrix

Reference	Strategic Role of IT	IT as a User	IT as an Enabler	Organizational Capabilities	Risks, Ethics, and Legal
Agrawal, 2023	X	X		X	X
Alavi et al., 2024	X	X		X	X
Baker, 2025		X	X		
Banh et al., 2025	X	X		X	X
Calyam et al., 2024			X		X
Campbell and Jovanovic, 2024			X	X	X
Chen et al., 2023	X	X			
Chennabasappa et al., 2025		X		X	
Chowdhury et al., 2024	X		X		X
Chui et al., 2023					
Desai and Desai, 2025		X	X	X	
Ding, 2024					
Dwivedi et al., 2023	X	X	X	X	X
Dwivedi et al., 2025	X	X	X	X	X
Dzhaparov, 2024	X	X		X	X
Ettinger, 2025				X	X
Feffer et al., 2024				X	
Gadde, 2024			X		
Golda et al., 2024					X
Gupta et al., 2023			X	X	X
Gupta and Rathore, 2024	X		X		
Gupta, 2024	X		X		X
Haki et al., 2025	X	X	X	X	X
Hilario et al., 2024		X	X		
Joshi, 2024			X		X
Joshi et al., 2025	X		X		X
Korzynski et al., 2023					X
Lee, 2025		X	X	X	
Li et al., 2024		X			
Malik-Kozłowska and Kozłowski, 2025	X			X	X
Manduchi et al., 2024			X		X
McCorkindale, 2024	X				X
Moharrak and Mogaji, 2024	X			X	X
Mondal et al., 2023	X	X			
Naqbi et al., 2024	X	X		X	
Nidhisree et al., 2024	X	X			
Sai et al., 2024	X				X
Schneider et al., 2024	X			X	X
Silva et al., 2024	X		X		
Singh et al., 2024	X		X		X
Singla et al., 2025		X			
Smith, 2025			X	X	
Storey et al., 2025	X		X		X
Peng et al., 2023					
Onatayo et al., 2024	X	X	X		
Ooi et al., 2023	X	X	X	X	X
Orchard and Tasiemski, 2023		X	X	X	
Rajaram & Tinguely, 2024				X	X
Reznikov, 2024		X			

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